WHAT OTHER CHOICE DO WE HAVE?

OUR LIVES ARE AT STAKE HERE...

BADUM BADUM BADUM BADUM

SURE IT WAS A GOOD IDEA LEAVING EVERYTHING TO CAKE... I MEAN, YOSHIWARA?

AT LAST, THE DAY OF RECKONING.

YOOO!

KITAHARAA! IMAMURAA!

SORRY WE'RE LATE!

Ch.10 The Mixer

WE'VE GOT THIS MIXER IN THE BAG.

HEH HEH HEH

LOOK AT HOW THEY'RE DRESSED.

Dressing casually? Please.

SOUNDS LIKE A GOOD HAUL!

THE GIRL WHO SET THIS UP SAID THEY'RE ALL FIRST-YEARS AT OUMI.

SO, WHAT SCHOOL ARE THE GIRLS FROM?

OH, HER?! CA- UHH...

HMM. LET'S SEE.

BY THE WAY, WHAT'S YOUR FRIEND LIKE?

A GO-GETTER, HUH?

GOTCHA.

My kinda girl.

HUH?!

SHE KNOWS WHEN TO TURN IT ON AND OFF.

WHA ...?

YOU'D BE A LIFE-SAVER!

HELP US OUT!

SHE DEFINITELY DIDN'T LOOK HAPPY WHEN WE ASKED HER.

WHY WAS SHE SO RELUCTANT TO INTRO-DUCE SOME FRIENDS TO US?

WHO ASKS SOMEONE WHO JUST JOINED TO PLAN A MIXER?

...

SIGH はー

WELL, I GUESS I DO OWE YOU GUYS.

YOU GUYS DON'T GET IT.

OF COURSE SHE WOULDN'T WANT TO.

WHY NOT?

WHO DO YOU THINK YOU'RE GOING TO A MIXER WITH?

WHAT HAP-PENED TO BEING BEST FRIENDS?

I'D BE SO EMBAR-RASSED I COULD JUST DIE.

BECAUSE SHE HAS TO INTRODUCE HER FRIENDS TO PERVERTS.

IORI HAS TO PRETEND TO BE CHII-CHAN'S BOY-FRIEND UNTIL SHE SAYS HE CAN STOP.

I TOLD YOU, CHISA'S JUST-

WAIT!

YEAH.

BESIDES, YOU HAVE A GIRL-FRIEND, SO OF COURSE SHE'D BE ANNOYED YOU'RE GOING.

WHACK ドカ

WHACK ドカ

WHACK ドカ

HE'S TAKEN, AFTER ALL.

GUESS THAT MEANS IORI'S ON BACKUP DUTY.

ERG ...

HEY, GUYS. WE'RE HERE.

YOU'LL BE SLEEPING WITH THE FISHES!

ARE YOU BRAG-GING, ASS-HOLE?!

JUST... MY GIRL-FRIEND.

JUST?

CEMENT

WAIT.

FWIP

WELL, LET'S GO.

I... I SEE.

IZAKAYA

MUMBO JUMBO

DING ピンポン DING

THE GIRLS ARE ALREADY HERE.

YEAH.

THIS IT?

I SEE.

POINT YOUR CHOP-STICKS AT WHICH GIRL YOU LIKE.

YEAH.

SO WE DON'T FIGHT OVER GIRLS HUH?

WHAT'S UP, NO-JIMA?

LET'S DECIDE ON A SIGNAL NOW.

SIG-NAL?

...POINT YOUR CHOPSTICKS AT YOURSELF TO SIGNAL THAT YOU GIVE UP.

AND IF YOU'RE NOT INTO ANY OF THEM...

...?

SCREW THAT...

THE GLASS-ES AREN'T JUST FOR SHOW.

GOOD IDEA.

HOW'S THAT SOUND?

I MADE A VOW TO MYSELF FOR TO-DAY.

B-BUT ...

I DON'T NEED A SIGNAL.

SCREW THAT.

YAMA-MOTO?

I'LL LOSE MY VIRGIN-ITY, AND I DON'T CARE TO WHO!

WHAT MACHISMO ...!

THIS MAN HAS THE MAKINGS OF A GREAT LEADER!

HE'S JUST A SCUMBAG WHO'LL TAKE ANYTHING HE CAN GET.

IZAKAYA MUMBO JUMBO

A NEW WORLD AWAITS!

LET'S GO!

OKAY, EVERYONE READY?

コツ BUMP

YEAH ...

NICE TO MEET YOU! ☆

CA

CA

CAAAAAA KE

CLACK

HEY, THERE. NICE TO MEET YOU.

WHAT?!

YOSHI-HARA, YOU BITCH...!

MM ーン!
HM ーン!
HM /
ん

HMM. DECI-SIONS, DECI-SIONS.

チュー CHIK

LET'S HAVE A TOAST!

WHAT DO YOU WANNA DRINK?

I KNOW, RIGHT?

IT'S HOT TODAY, HUH?

HE ヲ
HE フ
HE フ
HE フ
HE

ウAH
フHA
フHA
フHA

WE SHOULD FALL BACK!

YOU'RE KID-DING!

JUST LOOK AT THEM!

スウ STARE ...

...

HELLO, FRIDAY!

I THINK I'LL START WITH BEER.

SMILE SMILE SMILE SMILE

YAMA-MOTO...

YOU'LL STILL TREAD ON?

YOU'RE A MODEL VIRGIN!

JOIN

I'LL START.

SURE.

WHY DON'T WE INTRO-DUCE OUR-SELVES?

CHEERS! わーい

WHAT ARE SOME OF YOUR HOB-BIES?!

TWISH

...

OOOH おぉ—

パチ パチ パチ CLAP CLAP CLAP

MY NAME'S KIYOKO KAMIO. I'M A FIRST-YEAR AT OUMI WOMEN'S UNIVERSITY.

パチ... CLAP

パチ... CLAP

HORSE RACING AND PACHIN-KO, I GUESS.

HMM.

TWIRL くるる TWIRL

...!

FWIP FWIP FWIP

GRIP

I'LL GO NEXT.

ニコ SMILE ニコ SMILE ニコ SMILE

YAMAMO-TOOO!

HE WON'T GIVE UP!

I CAN'T COLD BACK THE TEARS!

カチャ CLACK

I'M KEIKO SUZUKI.

カケル CAAAKE

KANA-KO IIDA.

ケイキイ CAKEEE

AND I'M AINA YOSHI-WARA.

アイナ SUPA CAKE

CLAP パチ

Nice, nice!

CLAP パチ…

CLAP パチ…

…

WE CAN'T LET SUCH A MACHO DISPLAY GO TO WASTE.

YEAH. THE LEAST WE CAN DO IS TRY TO HYPE THINGS UP.

DUDES! YAMAMOTO'S TRYING SO HARD!

THUD

NOW, THEN ...

HAJIME NOJIMA!

I'M KOHEI IMA-MURA!

I'M IORI KITAHARA, A FIRST-YEAR AT IZU U!

WOOO!

CLAP

CLAP

CLAP

I'M SITTING HERE!

I GOT THIS ONE!

I'M SWITCHING TO THIS SEAT!

YOU...

BA

YOU GUYS...!

DOOM

FWIP

SNIFF...!

...!

GOOD LUCK!

LEAVE HER TO ME!

WE'VE GOT YOUR BACK!

HEH
HEH
HEH
HEH
HEH
HA
HA
HA
HA
HA
GREAT.
HMM
MMM
うん
NOW...
THUD
...THE REAL PROBLEM IS THIS MONSTER.
WHAT'LL YOU HAVE, KITA-HARA?
GRRR

YOU ...

...

BE SOCIAL AND KEEP THE MOOD ELEVATED!

YOU GUYS KNOW YOUR JOB AS BACKUP, RIGHT?

OF COURSE.

HMM?

YOU LOOK AWFULLY DIFFERENT FROM THE OTHER DAY, YOSHIWARA.

WELL, YEAH.

IT'S A MIXER, AFTER ALL.

Y-YEAH.

SHE DOES.

FLINCH ビク"

WINK バチ

REAL-LY?

I HARDLY RECOG-NIZED HER.

HER CLOTHES AND ***MAKEUP***, FOR EXAM-PLE.

UHH, LIKE ...

HOW SO?

GRRR

SNAP
SNAP

AHHH

TWIRL
TWIRL
BONK

I WENT ALL OUT!

☆

OUR JOB IS TO FORGE THAT BRAVE SOUL INTO A REAL MAN!

WHISPER

CALM DOWN, GUYS!

WHISPER

S-SORRY.

WHISPER

GULP GULP GULP

SHE'S JUST SO IRRITAT-ING.

WHISPER

HEY, YOU TWO! YOUR GLASS-ES ARE EMPTY!

!

...!

HUFF

HUFF

HOW 'BOUT YOU THROW THAT SPIRIT IN THE TRASH?

FWIP

EASE UP THE MOOD, HUH?

WHISPER

Oh, yeah?

You like gar-dening, huh?

あはは AH HA HA HA

ALL RIGHT.

WHISPER

WHY DON'T WE GET EVERY-ONE ON A FIRST-NAME BASIS?

WHISPER

HOW SHOULD WE BACK HIM UP, ANYWAY?

WHISPER

ONCE AGAIN...

FWIP

ROG-ER!

HERE WE GO! FOL-LOW MY LEAD!

I'M IORI KITA-HARA.

YOU CAN CALL ME IORI.

HAJIME NOJIMA.

HAJIME IS FINE.

CA-

CALL ME KOHEI.

OH, YOU CAN CALL ME KANAKO, THEN.

PEOPLE CALL ME KIKKO. ♪

CLENCH

I-I'M SHINICHIRO.

THEN, CALL ME...

H-HEY, WAIT!

WHAT'S UP, YOSHI-WARA?

WELL, Y'KNOW ... I...

WON'T PEOPLE IN PAB GET THE WRONG IDEA IF WE SWITCH TO FIRST NAMES SO SOON?

SNAP

WHAT'S WITH THE GENUINE REAC-TION?

SHE KILLED THE FLOW...

DON'T FOR-GET YOUR DUTY!

WHISPER ボソ

WHISPER ボソ

KITA-HARA!

GASP

GULP ゴックン

GULP

WHOA, THERE, KITAHARA! LOOKS LIKE YOUR BOTTLE'S EMPTY THIS TIME!

AS IF, CAKE FACE.

B-BUT...

IF YOU REALLY WANT TO CALL ME BY MY FIRST NAME, KITA-IORI...

FWAP ビィィィ

YOU CAN REAL-LY PUT IT AWAY, MAN!

THIS IS ALL FOR OUR BROTHER IN ARMS!

THAT'S RIGHT!

Sure, I know. It's tasty, huh?

Aroma-therapy?

WELL SAID!

I REALLY WANT TO CALL YOU AINA...!

7" GRIT

HM?

I...

WHAT?

WHISPER ボソッ

SAY, UMM ...

IORI?

FIDG もじ

FIDG もじ

もじもじ

OH ...

OKAY.

COULD YOU REPEAT YOURSELF? I DIDN'T REALLY CATCH THAT.

?

DON'T YOU HAVE A HEART?!

DON'T GIVE IN, KITA-HARA!

BWAAAH ぃやぁ

I CAN'T TAKE IT ANY-MORE!

SORRY FOR THE WAIT.

HERE'S YOUR RAMEN SALAD.

TA DA

DUM

OH, CAN I TAKE A PICTURE?

I'VE NEVER SEEN IT BE-FORE.

It's a big deal in Hokkaido.

YOU'VE NEVER HEARD OF RAMEN SALAD?

WHAT'S THIS?

YOU LOVE TAKING PIC-TURES, HUH, KANAKO?

WHAT KIND DO YOU USUALLY TAKE?

YAPPY

STUFF LIKE THIS.

YAPPY

カシャ

SNAP

SO, UH...

CAN WE EAT YET?

?!

THESE GUYS...

What happened to no fighting over girls?

WHIP

I LOVE MOVIES, TOO.

WHIP

YEAH, AND MOVIES.

...

SO, YOU LIKE PHOTO-GRAPHY, KANAKO-CHAN?

WHIP

WHAT?!

THE BASTARD CHANGED HIS TAR-GET!

WHIP

I SAW THAT MOVIE, TOO.

I SAW LOVE WEB THE OTHER DAY.

WAIT A SECOND.

YOU CAN'T HAVE HER, KITAHARA!

THNK

THNK

BACK OFF, NOJIMA!

WHAT HAVE YOU SEEN RECENTLY?

MOVIES ARE GREAT, HUH?

? ? ?

...

TOTALLY!

ずいSHOVE

THAT WAS A GOOD MOVIE, HUH?

ずいSHOVE

OHH, THAT?

ずいSHOVE

MY TASTES LIE IN ANOTHER DIMEN-SION...

HOW STUPID. THEY'RE JUST 3D.

ANIMASTER

RARAKO-TAN?!

DVD BOX

NEW!

DISSOLVE! MAGICAL GIRL RARAKO

THAT DVD...

The main character of **Dissolve! Magical Girl Rarako**, the anime that changed Kohei's life.

FWIP

...SHE'S A KINDRED SPIRIT (ANGEL)?!

DON'T TELL ME...

DO-

IT WAS A ROMANCE MOVIE...

I LIKE THE SCENE WITH THE JUMP.

NO, NO. THE UNDERWATER SCENE WAS WAY BETTER.

I LOVED THAT SCENE WITH THE EXPLOSION!

HMM. YOU LIKE THAT MOVIE, HUH?

ME, TOO.

I... I DO, TOO!

SAY...

KOHEI?

SWIF

HUH?!

SAY WHAAAAT?!

...WOULD YOU LIKE TO COME TO MY PLACE AFTER THIS?

THUD

PIT PIT PAT PAT PAT...

I-I'M GONNA GO TO THE REST-ROOM.

OH, ME, TOO.

GUESS I'LL GO, TOO.

ME, THREE.

PAT PIT PAT PIT PAT PIT

WHOA, GUYS. CHILL.

KITA-HARA ...?

STICK TO YOUR GIRL, JACKASS!

LIKE I GIVE A SHIT!

WHAT HAP-PENED TO BACKING ME UP?!

Just watch. I'll overcome dimen-sions.

NO KIDDING.

THAT KINDA TALK WON'T HELP YOU GET YOU A GIRL-FRIEND.

THE HELL ARE YOU TALKING ABOUT?

TEAM-WORK IS THE KEY TO VICTORY.

NOTHING GOOD COMES FROM JEALOU-SY.

PTOO

TCH

WE'RE FRIENDS, RIGHT?

BUT...!

I SEE!

TODAY'S MIXER IS FOR THE SAKE OF TOMOR-ROW'S.

TOMOR-ROW'S MIXER IS FOR THE SAKE OF THE NEXT.

KITA-HARA!

YOU'RE ABSO-LUTELY RIGHT!

!

IF SOME-ONE HOOKS UP, WE CAN JUST HAVE ANOTHER MIXER.

NOW IS THE TIME TO SHOW THE STRENGTH OF OUR BROTHER-HOOD!

UNDER-STAND?

OF COURSE!

LET'S GRASP VICTORY TOGETH-ER!

WHISPER ボソ

THERE'S NO ROOM FOR TRICK-STERS IN OUR BROTHER-HOOD.

WHISPER ボソ

I WON'T FORGIVE HIM FOR TRY-ING TO SLIP AHEAD.

WHISPER ボソ

HOW CAN WE SABOTAGE THAT SLIP-PERY CHEAT?

For real? Wow!

Apparently, the lead actress has visited our diving shop.

IT WAS GOOD, HUH?

REAL-LY?

I'VE SEEN THAT SHOW, TOO.

IMA-MURA?

FWIP

DON'T WOR-RY.

LEAVE EVERY-THING TO ME.

TOPPLING HIM NOW IS A TALL ORDER, BUT...

BUT WHAT SHOULD WE DO? WE'VE ALREADY AGREED TO WORK TO-GETHER.

SWIF

IN THE NAME OF JUSTICE, VENGEANCE WILL BE MINE.

YOUR ANGER AND REGRET WON'T GO UNHEARD.

WHAT DO YOU WANT, KOHEI?

TCH

HEY, KITAHARA.

スッ SWIT

JUST STRIKING UP CONVERSATION.

IMAMURA ...

I-

WHAT?!

H-HERESY!

THAT FIEND!

HOW ARE THINGS BETWEEN YOU AND YOUR GIRLFRIEND LATELY?

THINGS WERE GOING SO WELL FOR ME...

IS HE THAT JEALOUS OF MY SUCCESS?!

WHAT THE HELL IS THIS SHITHEAD SAYING?

MY COM-RADES HAVE MY BA-

BUT WE'RE A TEAM.

IT'S NO USE! THEY'RE ALL SHITHEADS!

ニヤ

ニヤ

I WAS SO CLOSE, GOD-DAMN IT!

ERG ...

WHAT? DON'T YOU HAVE A GIRL-FRIEND, KITAHARA?

ユラア SWAY

HE JUST BROKE THE TABOO OF MIXERS AS IF IT WAS NOTHING!

DO I HAVE NO CHOICE...

...BUT TO GIVE UP ON IT?!

THE FUN CAMPUS LIFE WITH A GIRLFRIEND I DREAMED OF...

OOH, SOUNDS GOOD.

HUH?

...

OH, LET'S GET DES-SERT.

I...

DID SHE THROW ME A LIFELINE?

I-IT CAN'T BE!

WHICH SHOULD I GET?

I WANT A CREPE!

THEN, I'LL GET ICE CREAM.

THEY HAVE ICE CREAM AND CREPES.

YEAH, THIS IS REALLY IMPORTANT.

WAIT, BEFORE THAT, THIS GUY HAS A GIRL-FRIEND...

SMILE!!

BE-SIDES,

C'MON!

THAT'S OKAY.

EHH?

LISTEN TO THIS FIRST! IT WON'T TAKE LONG.

HANG ON!

FWIP

ピロリン

CRACK

AINA ALREADY TOLD US IORI-KUN HAS A GIRL-FRIEND.

NOTHING HAPPENED IN THE END.

UTTER DEFEAT ...

WHY DID I WASTE ALL THAT TIME AND MONEY?

...

IZAKAYA MUMBO JUMBO

SLUMP

WHAT'S UP, KITA-HARA?

...

SWAY フラ フラ SWAY

THANKS GUYS! ☆

THE MOMENT THEY TURNED THEIR BACKS TO US...

THOSE GIRLS ...

HEAR WHAT?

HM?

DIDN'T YOU GUYS HEAR THAT?

YEAH! IT WAS A BLAST!

YEAH?

THAT WAS THE BEST, AINA.

THAT WAS FUN.

LIKE GOING TO THE ZOO!

A ZOO, HUH?

I SEE.

A-HA.

...THEY SAID.

...

WHY DON'T YOU TRY LOOKING IN THE MIR-ROR?!

WHO'RE YOU CALLING ANI-MALS?!

DON'T FUCK WITH US!

YOU BITCHES LOOK LIKE A BUNCH OF CLOWNS!

POST-MORTEM SESSION, LET'S GO!

I'M NOT GOIN' HOME LIKE THIS!

GREAT IDEA!

SCREW THIS! LET'S DRINK!

HEY, AINA.

WAS THAT WHAT YOU HAD IN MIND?

Kiyoko Kamio

YEAH. SORRY FOR ASKING YOU TO DO SOMETHING SO WEIRD.

Aina Yoshiwara

Kanako Iida

IT'S FINE. WEARING MAKEUP LIKE THAT WAS PRET-TY FUN.

YOU'RE LETTING US COPY YOUR REPORT, ANYWAY.

Keiko Suzuki

GOING TO A MIXER DRESSED LIKE THAT. THERE COULD'VE BEEN A NICE GUY THERE.

NO WORRIES. THAT WASN'T THE FIRST TIME THEY'VE SEEN ME LIKE THAT.

YOU SURE THAT WAS OKAY, AINA?

WAS WHAT OKAY?

...

NOT LIKE WE CAN TALK.

LOOK AT THIS PICTURE.

OH, MY GOD.

あはは AHAHA

SEND IT TO ME!

You're not wrong, but...

COME ON...

YEAH, I GUESS THEY'VE ALREADY SEEN YOU AT YOUR WORST.

AHH, YOU MEAN THAT WHOLE DEAL?

BESIDES...

HM?

SEE?

HILARIOUS, RIGHT?

DON'T YOU THINK A SOUL-MATE IS SOMEONE WHO'LL BE NICE TO YOU...

...NO MAT-TER WHAT YOU LOOK LIKE?

HEY! LEAVE ME ALONE!

YOU WATCH TOO MUCH TV, AINA!

THERE SHE GOES AGAIN!

AH, HA, HA!

DEATH TO TRAITORS!

WE'RE BROTH-ERS!

QUIT GRUM-BLING, KITA-HARA!

I COULD'VE GONE HOME WITH KANAKO-CHAN IF YOU GUYS HADN'T GOTTEN IN THE WAY!

CH.10 / End


YEP.
AHH.
YEAH, BUT HIS CLOTHES ...
He basically asked you out.
WHAT ABOUT IMA-MURA-KUN, KANAKO?

Grand Blue Dreaming